PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2024 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (segregation and discrimination faced by Black Americans in the Deep South during the 1950s):

• **Inference 1:** Black Americans faced constant, humiliating racial restrictions in public spaces and commercial establishments.

- *Detail from source:* "We were barred from drinking fountains designated for whites, kept at the back of commercial establishments, and expected to yield the sidewalk to white pedestrians."

• **Inference 2:** Any challenge to segregation was met with immediate, harsh punishment from white authorities and vigilantes.

- *Detail from source:* "Violations of these unwritten laws brought swift retribution from local police or white groups. Segregation was a constant, daily humiliation."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

Target: AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

"One reason why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 was that Vietcong guerrilla tactics neutralized American military and technological superiority." The Vietcong avoided large-scale battles, using ambushes and hiding in complex underground tunnel networks. They deployed cheap, lethal **booby traps**, such as Punji stake pits and tripwires, which caused roughly **11%** of US deaths. *Therefore, Vietcong guerrilla tactics were a vital cause of why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 because they created a constant state of fear and paranoia, rendering US air support and heavy weaponry ineffective.*

"A second reason why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 was that US tactics like the use of chemical weapons actively alienated the Vietnamese peasantry." The US military sprayed millions of gallons of **Agent Orange** to destroy the jungle canopy and crops, destroying the livelihoods of innocent peasants. This chemical warfare, alongside the destructive **Search and Destroy** raids that burned villages, completely undermined the policy of winning **hearts and minds**. *Therefore, the alienation of the rural population was a crucial reason why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 because it led to local peasants providing the Vietcong with food, shelter, and vital intelligence.*

"A third reason why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 was low troop morale and the one-year rotation system." The draft system meant that US soldiers were young, inexperienced conscripts who only served a **one-year tour** of duty. Just as soldiers gained combat experience, they were sent home and replaced by raw recruits, which led to drug abuse, low commitment, and the fragging of officers. *Therefore, the lack of combat continuity and low troop commitment were decisive reasons why the USA was not able to win the war against the Vietcong in the years 1964–73 because they made it impossible for the US army to defeat the highly motivated Vietcong forces.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for showing Martin Luther King's ability to mobilize massive, diverse public support and project national leadership during the civil rights movement. The photograph depicts King waving to a huge, peaceful crowd along the Lincoln Memorial reflecting pool, representing the scale and racial diversity of the March on Washington. This utility is supported by my knowledge that the March on Washington in August 1963 attracted over 250,000 demonstrators and culminated in King's famous 'I Have a Dream' speech, which successfully pressured President Kennedy to support civil rights legislation and gained positive national publicity. The provenance of a photograph taken on the day of the march makes it highly useful as a primary visual record of the event's scale and optimistic mood. However, as a photograph, it is limited because it only captures a single moment of triumph and public harmony, omitting the behind-the-scenes political compromises and the ongoing segregationist hostility in the Deep South.

Source C is highly useful for showing the limits of King's success when campaigning in Northern cities, and his role in temporarily bridging ideological splits. The activist states that King "failed to get improved living conditions" in Chicago and that after his departure in late 1966, a major split between Black and White activists became visible, leading Black activists to ask Whites to leave the movement. This content's usefulness is validated by my knowledge that the Chicago Freedom Movement in 1966 faced fierce opposition from Mayor Daley and made little progress in tackling housing slums or poverty, which contributed to the rise of Black Power ideas that rejected white collaboration. The provenance of an account by a Black civil rights leader in Chicago who worked closely with King increases its utility because it offers a realistic, critical insider's view of the campaign's limitations and the growing radicalization of activists, though as a later television interview, it may reflect the fragmented landscape of the post-1966 movement.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 highlights King's **"emphasis on nonviolent direct action"** which won federal support and new laws. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that despite the progress, the **"daily economic realities for urban Black Americans remained unchanged"**, particularly in northern cities where segregation persisted.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have relied on different sources. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which shows King addressing the crowd at the March on Washington, leading to the view that King's **"emphasis on nonviolent direct action"** won support and new laws. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which focuses on how King "did not succeed in securing better housing conditions" in Chicago, leading to the view that **"daily economic realities for urban Black Americans remained unchanged"** in the North.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a moderate extent with Interpretation 2 that King's achievements failed to change the daily lives of many Black Americans, particularly in the North. In **1966**, King launched the **Chicago Freedom Movement** to combat housing discrimination. Although Mayor Daley signed an agreement to end segregation, the city authorities ignored it once King left, and housing conditions in the slums remained unchanged. As Bob Lucas notes in Source C, King **failed to get improved living conditions** in Chicago, and his departure exposed a wide split where Black activists asked whites to leave. This supports Interpretation 2's view that practical desegregation was **"not achieved"** in the North and **"daily economic realities for urban Black Americans remained unchanged"**.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in emphasizing the monumental impact of King's Southern campaigns. King's commitment to non-violent direct action, as shown in the massive crowd at the March on Washington in Source B, attracted international support and led to the **Civil Rights Act of 1964** and the **Voting Rights Act of 1965**. This supports Interpretation 1's claim that King's **"emphasis on nonviolent direct action"** put pressure on the government to end discrimination against Black Americans and secured landmark laws.

Overall, while the 1964 Act was a massive victory for social desegregation, the 1965 Voting Rights Act was the ultimate achievement because it gave Black Americans the political power to defend their rights. Without the vote, the social gains of 1964 could not be legally enforced or protected at the local level.